

module-12-movement-of-sun - Darshana (60-min workshop)

IKS Curriculum - middle band

Module 12 — Movement of the Sun (Darśana)

Sanskrit: *Sūrya-gati* · **Band:** Middle (6-8) · **Duration:** 60 min · **Path:** Darśana (Workshop)

Solar year, solstices, equinoxes, and the 12 rāśis.

Darśana note. This workshop condenses Module 12's full 10-day arc into one hour. For the deeper version — daily lesson plans, quizzes, assessments, slide decks — switch to [Adhyayana](#) (the Full Course path).

Opening hook · 5 min

Project a sunrise-direction composite (12 photos, one per month, same location). “*The sunrise drifts north and south through the year. Why?*” (Earth's axial tilt.) “*Today: the Indian framework — uttarāyaṇa, dakṣiṇāyana, and the 12 rāśis.*”

Core idea · 15 min

The Sun's annual journey:

1. **Axial tilt** (23.5°) → Sun's apparent path drifts north/south.
 2. **Uttarāyaṇa** (Dec 21 → June 21): Sun rises further north each day.
 3. **Dakṣiṇāyana** (June 21 → Dec 21): Sun rises further south each day.
 4. **Solstices:** June 21 (Sun farthest north), Dec 21 (farthest south).
 5. **Equinoxes:** March 21, Sept 22 (Sun crosses the equator, day = night everywhere).
 6. **12 rāśis:** the ecliptic divided into $12 \times 30^\circ$ segments. Sun travels through ~1 rāśi per month.
 7. **Saṅkrānti:** the day Sun moves from one rāśi to the next. Makara Saṅkrānti (Sun enters Capricorn) ~ Jan 14.
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Demonstration · 10 min

Globe + torch demo: tilt the globe, walk torch around. Show how axial tilt creates seasons. Compute today's ayanāmśa (use a panchanga app).

Source moment · 5 min

Paraphrase Sūrya-siddhānta, ch. 14: *“The Sun travels along the ecliptic. In one year it completes one revolution through the 12 rāśis.”*

Hands-on activity · 15 min

Personal solar calendar. Mark current month, ayanāṁśa, current rāśi, next saṅkrānti. Predict your birthday’s rāśi (use a panchanga). Compare with classmates.

Reflection + take-home · 10 min

“Why does Makara Saṅkrānti (Jan 14) not match the December solstice exactly? What does the gap tell us?”

Go deeper into Adhyayana

The 10 days you’re skipping if you only do this workshop:

- **Day 01** — Sun’s yearly path
- **Day 02** — Axial tilt and seasons
- **Day 03** — Uttarāyaṇa and Dakṣiṇāyana
- **Day 04** — Equinoxes — viṣuva
- **Day 05** — 12 rāśis
- **Day 06** — Saṅkrānti moments
- **Day 07** — Sāyana vs nirayana — the ayanāṁśa
- **Day 08** — Precession of equinoxes
- **Day 09** — Cross-cultural calendars — solar systems
- **Day 10** — Final share + personal calendar

→ [Open the Adhyayana track for this module](#) to access all 10 days, the 4-audience PDFs, the slide deck, the quizzes, and the project rubric.